

Word family: **blank** / blanks / blanked / blanking / blankly / blankness

Base word: blank

Plural noun: blanks

Past tense: blanked

Past participle: blanked

-ing form: blanking

Related forms: blankly, blankness

Useful constructions/extensions: go blank, draw a blank, blank expression, blank face, blank page, blank screen, fill in the blank, leave something blank, blank space, blank cheque/check, blank someone, blank out, point-blank

Part of speech: adjective (形容詞) / noun (名詞) / verb (動詞) / related adverb and noun forms (相關副詞及名詞)

Your passage contains:

> “My heart would race, my mind would go **blank**, and I would start imagining the worst.”

Here, **blank** means:

temporarily containing no usable thoughts, words, or memories.

Meaning in this passage

In:

> **my mind would go blank**

blank does not literally mean that the mind is physically empty.

It means:

you suddenly become unable to think of what to say, remember prepared material, or organize your thoughts.

This often happens because of:

- * nervousness;
- * pressure;
- * fear;
- * surprise;
- * being put on the spot.

Meaning: Temporarily unable to think, remember, or produce the information you need.

****繁體中文： ** 因緊張、壓力或突然受驚而腦袋一片空白，短暫想不起內容或無法正常思考****

****中文翻譯： ****

> “My heart would race, my mind would go blank...”

「我會心跳加速，**腦袋一片空白**.....」

So:

****go blank = 突然一片空白 / 突然想不起來****

****my mind goes blank = 我突然無法思考或想不起要說甚麼****

1. ****mind goes blank (腦袋一片空白) — 突然想不起來；無法思考****

This is the exact use in your passage.

Practice 1 — Original

> “My mind would go ****blank****.”

「我的腦袋會突然****一片空白****。」

Practice 2

> “When the manager asked me a question, my mind went ****blank****.”

「經理問我問題時，我的腦袋突然****一片空白**，完全想不到答案******。」

Practice 3

> “I knew the answer, but my mind suddenly went ****blank****.”

「我其實知道答案，但腦袋突然****一片空白**，完全想不起來******。」

****go blank = 因緊張、壓力或突發情況而短暫無法回想、組織或產生所需的想法 / 語言****

2. ****blank = empty / containing nothing (空白的) — 空白的；沒有內容的****

This is the broad literal core meaning.

****Meaning:**** Containing no writing, marks, information, or other content.

Practice 4

> “He handed me a ****blank sheet of paper****.”

「他遞給我一張****空白紙****。」

Practice 5

> “The form contains several ****blank spaces****.”

「表格上有幾個****空白位置****。」

****blank** = 沒有文字、圖案、資料或其他內容的******

3. ****blank page** (空白頁) — 空白頁；未寫過的頁面******

Practice 6

> “I stared at the ****blank page**** and didn’t know how to begin.”

「我望著****空白頁****，不知道該如何開始。」

Practice 7

> “Open your notebook to a ****blank page****.”

「把筆記簿翻到一張****空白頁****。」

****blank page** = 尚未寫上 / 印上任何主要內容的頁面******

4. ****blank screen** (空白畫面) — 空白螢幕；沒有顯示內容的畫面******

A very common technology use.

Practice 8

> “The computer suddenly showed a ****blank screen****.”

「電腦突然顯示一個****空白畫面****。」

Practice 9

> “If you only see a **blank screen**, restart the application.”

「如果你只看到**空白畫面**，請重新啟動應用程式。」

blank screen = 螢幕本身開著 / 存在，但沒有顯示預期內容

5. **leave something blank** (留空) — 不填；留空

A very common form/document construction.

Practice 10

> “If the question does not apply to you, leave the box **blank**.”

「如果問題不適用於你，請把方格**留空**。」

Practice 11

> “She left the answer section **blank**.”

「她把答案欄**留空**了。」

leave something blank = 不在指定位置填寫、輸入或加入內容

6. **blank space/field** (空白欄 / 空位) — 空白位置；未填欄位

Practice 12

> “Enter your name in the **blank field**.”

「請在**空白欄位**輸入你的姓名。」

Practice 13

> “Write the missing word in the **blank space**.”

「把缺少的詞寫在**空白位置**。」

blank space/field = 特意留空、等待使用者填寫內容的位置

7. **a blank** = empty space to be completed (空格) — 空格；待填位置

Now **blank** is a noun.

Practice 14

> “Fill in the **blank** with the correct word.”

「用正確的詞填入**空格**。」

Practice 15

> “There are five **blanks** in the exercise.”

「這項練習有五個**空格**。」

a blank = 題目、表格或文字中故意留下、需要填入內容的空位

8. **fill in the blank** (填空) — 填空；填入缺少的內容

A very common learning/testing expression.

Practice 16

> “Please **fill in the blank** with the correct verb.”

「請用正確動詞**填空**。」

Practice 17

> “Students had to **fill in the blanks**.”

「學生需要**填寫空格**。」

fill in the blank(s) = 把缺少的字、數字或資料填入指定空位

9. **blank** = missing / omitted information (缺少內容的) — 遺漏的；未填的

Practice 18

> “The address field is still **blank**.”

「地址欄仍然是**空白 / 未填寫的**。」

Practice 19

> “Several entries were **blank** in the database.”

「資料庫中有幾項資料仍然**空缺**。」

blank = 應該有資料的位置目前沒有任何內容

10. **blank expression** (毫無表情) — 茫然 / 沒有表情的

A major figurative adjective sense.

Meaning: Showing no visible emotion, understanding, recognition, or reaction.

Practice 20

> “He gave me a **blank expression**.”

「他用一副**茫然、毫無表情的樣子**看著我。」

Practice 21

> “The audience stared back with **blank expressions**.”

「觀眾用一副副**茫然 / 沒有反應的表情**看回來。」

blank expression = 臉上看不出情緒、理解或反應的表情

11. **blank face/look** (茫然的臉 / 眼神) — 茫然 ; 毫無反應

Practice 22

> “She looked at me with a **blank face**.”

「她一臉**茫然 / 沒有表情**地看著我。」

Practice 23

> “His **blank look** showed that he had not understood the question.”

「他**茫然的眼神**顯示他沒有明白問題。」

blank face/look = 表情或眼神中看不出理解、情緒或明確反應

12. **stare blankly** (茫然地看) — 茫然地；沒有反應地

Here **blankly** is an adverb.

Practice 24

> “She stared at the slide **blankly**.”

「她**茫然地**望著投影片。」

Practice 25

> “He looked **blankly** at me when I mentioned the name.”

「我提到那個名字時，他**一臉茫然地**看著我。」

blankly = 沒有顯示理解、認出、情緒或反應地

13. **blank** = without memory/recollection (沒有記憶的) — 想不起來的；記憶空白的

Closely related to the passage sense.

Practice 26

> “Everything after that moment is a complete **blank**.”

「那一刻之後發生的事情，我的記憶完全是**一片空白**。」

Practice 27

> “There is a **blank** in my memory of that evening.”

「我對那晚的記憶有一段**空白**。」

a blank in memory = 某一段時間 / 事件完全無法回想起來

14. **draw a blank (想不起來 / 找不到結果) — 毫無結果；想不到**

A very common idiom.

Practice 28

> “I tried to remember his name but **drew a blank**.”

「我努力想他的名字，但最後**完全想不起來**。」

Practice 29

> “We searched the records but **drew a blank**.”

「我們搜尋紀錄，但最後**一無所獲**。」

draw a blank = 嘗試記起、尋找或取得某個結果，但最後完全沒有成功

This can refer to:

- * memory;
- * search;
- * investigation.

15. **blank = expressionless / emotionless (毫無情緒的) — 毫無表情的；冷淡空洞的**

Practice 30

> “Her face remained **blank**.”

「她的臉一直**毫無表情**。」

Practice 31

> “He answered in a **blank**, emotionless voice.”

「他用**毫無感情、空洞的聲音**回答。」

blank = 沒有明顯情感、反應或個人色彩的

16. **blank** = empty of ideas/inspiration (沒有想法的) — 沒有靈感；想不到內容

Practice 32

> “I sat there completely **blank**, unable to think of an opening.”

「我坐在那裡完全**想不到任何東西**，連開場白也想不出來。」

Practice 33

> “When asked for an example, I suddenly felt **blank**.”

「被要求舉例時，我突然**甚麼都想不到**。」

blank = 暫時沒有可用的想法、答案或靈感

This is very close to **mind goes blank**.

17. **blank** = plain / without decoration or printing (沒有圖案 / 標記的) — 素面的；空白的

Practice 34

> “Use a **blank card** for the message.”

「請用一張**沒有預印文字的空白卡**寫訊息。」

Practice 35

> “The notebook has a **blank cover**.”

「筆記簿有一個**素面 / 沒有圖案的封面**。」

blank = 表面沒有文字、圖案、符號或裝飾的

18. **blank form/document** (空白表格 / 文件) — 未填寫的表格

Practice 36

> “Please download a **blank form**.”

「請下載一份**空白表格**。」

Practice 37

> “The folder contains several **blank templates**.”

「資料夾內有幾份**空白範本**。」

blank form/template = 已有格式 / 欄位，但尚未填入實際資料的文件

19. **blank cheque/check** (空白支票) — 空白支票

Literal meaning first.

Practice 38

> “Never sign a **blank cheque**.”

「千萬不要簽署**空白支票**。」

Practice 39

> “The amount had not been written on the **blank check**.”

「那張**空白支票**尚未填上金額。」

blank cheque/check = 已簽署或準備使用，但某些關鍵資料尚未填寫的支票

British spelling:

> cheque

American spelling:

> check

20. **blank cheque/check** (全權授權) — 不受限制的授權；全權處理權

A major figurative extension.

Practice 40

> “The board did not give management a **blank cheque**.”

「董事會沒有給管理層**毫無限制的全權授權**。」

Practice 41

> “Giving someone a **blank check** to spend is risky.”

「給某人**不受限制的花費權**很有風險。」

give someone a blank cheque/check = 給某人極大自由 / 權力去決定或花費，而沒有明確限制

21. **blank cartridge / blank ammunition (空包彈) — 空包彈**

A distinct noun/adjective sense.

Practice 42

> “The weapon was loaded with **blank cartridges**.”

「武器裝的是**空包彈**。」

Practice 43

> “The actors used **blanks** during filming.”

「演員拍攝時使用了**空包彈**。」

blank ammunition / a blank = 沒有普通實彈彈頭、用來產生聲響 / 效果的彈藥

This is a distinct technical sense.

22. **fire blanks (發射空包彈) — 打空包彈**

Practice 44

> “The soldiers were **firing blanks** during the exercise.”

「士兵在演習中**發射空包彈**。」

Practice 45

> “The gun contained only **blanks**.”

「槍內只有**空包彈**。」

blanks = 空包彈

23. **blank key/card/disc** (未編碼 / 未寫入的) — 空白的 ; 未寫入的

A technical/data-storage extension.

Practice 46

> “The system writes the data to a **blank card**.”

「系統把資料寫入一張**未寫入資料的空白卡**。」

Practice 47

> “We need a **blank storage device**.”

「我們需要一個**尚未寫入資料的儲存裝置**。」

blank = 尚未記錄、寫入或編碼內容的

This is less common now with some older media, but the underlying use remains understandable.

24. **blank** = zero / no score (零分 / 沒有得分) — 零 ; 沒有得分

A sports-related extension, more often in derived constructions.

Practice 48

> “The home team was held to a **blank**.”

「主隊被壓制至**零得分**。」

Practice 49

> “The goalkeeper helped keep the opposition **blank**.”

「守門員協助令對手**未能得分**。」

This usage is more regional/sports-specific and is lower priority for general learners.

25. **blank someone (故意不理某人) — 無視 ; 不理睬**

Now **blank** is a verb, especially common in British informal English.

Practice 50

> “I said hello, but she completely **blanked me**.”

「我跟她打招呼，但她完全**無視我 / 不理我**。」

Practice 51

> “He **blanked** his former colleague at the event.”

「他在活動上故意**不理睬前同事**。」

blank someone = 故意不承認、回應或理會某人

Register:

informal, especially British English

26. **blank = fail to remember (突然想不起來) — 忘掉 ; 腦中空白**

A verb use especially in informal American English.

Practice 52

> “I completely **blanked** on her name.”

「我突然完全**想不起她的名字**。」

Practice 53

> “Sorry, I **blanked** for a moment.”

「對不起，我剛才突然**腦袋一片空白**。」

blank / blank on something = 突然無法想起原本知道的資料

This directly relates to your passage sense.

27. **blank out = forget / lose awareness temporarily (突然忘記 / 失去記憶) — 一片空白；失去記憶**

This is a phrasal verb, so it belongs outside the core bare-word senses, but it is useful enough to flag.

Practice 54

> “I **blanked out** during the interview.”

「我面試期間突然**腦袋一片空白**。」

Practice 55

> “She **blanked out** part of the conversation.”

「她對那段對話有一部分**完全沒有記憶**。」

blank out = 暫時無法思考 / 記憶，或完全忘記某段內容

28. **blank out = deliberately cover/remove information (遮掉 / 刪除) — 遮蓋；刪去**

Another phrasal use.

Practice 56

> “The personal details were **blanked out**.”

「個人資料被**遮掉 / 刪去**了。」

Practice 57

> “Please **blank out** the account number before sharing the image.”

「分享圖片前，請先把帳戶號碼**遮蓋掉**。」

blank out information = 刻意把文字 / 資料遮掉、刪除或使其不可見

29. **blank = erase / remove completely (抹去) — 抹去；消除**

A less common bare-verb sense.

Practice 58

> “The system **blanked** the display.”

「系統把顯示畫面**清空**了。」

Practice 59

> “The screen was temporarily **blanked**.”

「畫面暫時被**清空 / 關掉顯示**。」

blank = 使畫面、區域或內容變成空白

More technical than everyday.

30. **blankly** (茫然 / 無表情地) — 茫然地 ; 木然地

A key related adverb.

Practice 60

> “He stared **blankly** at the question.”

「他**茫然地**望著問題。」

Practice 61

> “She nodded **blankly**, clearly confused.”

「她**茫然地**點了點頭，顯然很困惑。」

blankly = 沒有表現出理解、認出、情緒或明確反應地

31. **blankness** (空白 / 茫然狀態) — 空白 ; 茫然

A related noun.

Practice 62

> “There was a moment of complete **blankness** in my mind.”

「我的腦中有一刻完全**一片空白**。」

Practice 63

> “The **blankness** of his expression made it hard to know what he was thinking.”

「他表情上的**茫然 / 毫無反應**令人難以知道他在想甚麼。」

blankness = 沒有內容、想法、表情或反應的狀態

32. **point-blank** (近距離 / 直截了當地) — 近距離地 ; 直截了當地

A lexicalized compound/adverbial expression.

It has two important meanings.

A. Very close range

> “The shot was fired at **point-blank range**.”

「那一槍是在**極近距離**開出的。」

B. Directly / bluntly

> “She asked me **point-blank** whether I wanted the job.”

「她**直截了當地**問我是否想要那份工作。」

point-blank = 極近距離地 ; 或毫不迂迴、非常直接地

This is a useful extension, not another core meaning of bare **blank**.

Important distinction: **blank** vs **empty**

These overlap, but are not identical.

blank

usually emphasizes:

- * no writing;
- * no information;
- * no visible expression;
- * no mental content.

> “a blank page”

= 空白頁

empty

usually emphasizes:

- * nothing physically inside.

> “an empty box”

= 空盒

Compare:

> **blank form**

= 尚未填資料的表格

> **empty box**

= 裡面沒有東西的盒子

A page can be **blank**, but we more naturally describe a container as **empty**.

Important distinction: **blank vs clear**

blank mind

= no thoughts / cannot recall.

clear mind

= able to think calmly and effectively.

> “My mind went blank.”

= 我甚麼都想不到。

> “I need a clear mind.”

= 我需要保持頭腦清醒。

They are nearly opposite mental states.

Important distinction: **go blank** vs **forget**

forget

= fail to remember something.

go blank

= temporarily lose access to thoughts/words, often suddenly under pressure.

Compare:

> “I forgot his name.”

= 我忘了他的名字。

> “My mind went blank when they asked me his name.”

= 他們問我名字時，我突然腦袋一片空白。

Go blank emphasizes the sudden mental shutdown.

Important distinction: **go blank** vs **draw a blank**

These are related but differ grammatically.

your mind goes blank

= you suddenly cannot think.

> “My mind went blank.”

you draw a blank

= your attempt to remember/find something produces no result.

> "I tried to remember, but I drew a blank."

So:

****go blank = 心智狀態突然空白****

****draw a blank = 嘗試後仍然完全沒有結果****

Important distinction: **blank expression vs blank mind**

**blank expression**

= the face shows no clear reaction/understanding.

**blank mind**

= the person internally cannot think/remember.

Someone can have:

> a blank expression

without actually having:

> a blank mind.

The first is outward appearance; the second is internal mental state.

Important distinction: **blank vs plain**

**blank**

= no writing/marking/content.

**plain**

= simple, without decoration or elaborate design.

Compare:

> “a blank sheet”

= 沒有任何文字的紙

> “a plain white shirt”

= 沒有花巧設計的白恤衫

Something can be plain without being blank.

Important distinction: **blank screen vs black screen**

These can be confused.

blank screen

= screen shows no expected content.

It could be:

- * white;
- * black;
- * empty background.

black screen

specifically means:

> the display appears black.

So **blank** describes absence of content, not necessarily color.

Important distinction: **blank form vs empty form**

blank form

is the standard phrase for:

> a form with fields not yet completed.

empty form

is possible technically, but less natural in ordinary administrative English.

So learners should prefer:

> **blank form**

= 空白表格

Important distinction: leave blank vs skip

leave blank

= intentionally put nothing in the space.

skip

= move past an item/question without doing it.

> "Leave question 5 blank."

= 第五題不要填。

> "Skip question 5."

= 跳過第五題。

The result may be similar, but the actions differ.

Important distinction: blank someone vs ignore someone

ignore

is broad and neutral:

> deliberately give no attention.

blank someone

informal, especially British:

> deliberately fail to acknowledge or respond to them socially.

> “She blanked me at the party.”

often suggests she acted as though she had not seen me.

Important distinction: **blank cheque/check** — literal vs figurative

Literal:

> “He signed a blank cheque.”

= 他簽了一張未填金額的空白支票。

Figurative:

> “They gave him a blank cheque.”

= 他們給了他**幾乎不受限制的決定 / 花費權**。

Same expression, very different practical meaning.

Important distinction: **blankly** vs **blindly**

These look similar but are very different.

blankly

= without expression or understanding.

> “He stared blankly.”

= 他茫然地望著。

blindly

= without seeing / without questioning or considering.

> “She followed the instructions blindly.”

= 她盲目地跟從指示。

Do not confuse them.

Important distinction: **blankness vs emptiness**

blankness

often concerns:

- * page/screen;
- * expression;
- * mind;
- * absence of identifiable content.

emptiness

is broader and often concerns:

- * physical absence;
- * emotional sense of inner emptiness.

> “the emptiness of the room”

= 房間空蕩蕩

> “a moment of mental blankness”

= 腦中一片空白

Family-extension sweep

The practical **blank** family is rich in physical emptiness, missing information, mental shutdown, facial expression, and several lexicalized expressions:

- * **go blank** = 腦袋一片空白
- * **blank — empty/unwritten** = 空白的
- * **blank page** = 空白頁
- * **blank screen** = 空白畫面
- * **leave blank** = 留空
- * **blank space/field** = 空白欄位
- * **a blank** = 空格
- * **fill in the blank** = 填空
- * **blank — missing information** = 未填寫 / 空缺的
- * **blank expression/face/look** = 茫然 / 毫無表情
- * **blankly** = 茫然地

* **blank — memory gap** = 記憶空白
 * **draw a blank** = 一無所獲 / 想不起來
 * **blank — no emotion** = 毫無情緒的
 * **blank — no inspiration** = 沒有想法 / 靈感的
 * **blank card/form/template** = 空白卡 / 表格 / 範本
 * **blank cheque/check — literal** = 空白支票
 * **blank cheque/check — figurative** = 不受限制的授權
 * **blank / blanks — ammunition** = 空包彈
 * **blank someone** = 故意無視某人 (尤其英式非正式)
 * **blank on something** = 突然想不起某事
 * **blank out — forget** = 突然失憶 / 腦袋空白
 * **blank out — obscure information** = 遮掉 / 刪除資料
 * **blankness** = 空白 / 茫然狀態
 * **point-blank** = 極近距離地 / 直截了當地

The main semantic branches are:

> **containing nothing**

> **missing information**

> **showing no expression/reaction**

> **mental absence / inability to remember**

> **specialized noun/verb extensions**

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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mind goes blank	因緊張、壓力或突發情況而短暫無法回想、組織或產生所需的想法 / 語言
blank — empty/unwritten	沒有文字、圖案、資料或其他內容的；空白的
blank page	尚未寫上或印上主要內容的頁面
blank screen	螢幕沒有顯示預期內容的空白畫面
leave something blank	不在指定位置填寫、輸入或加入任何內容
blank space/field	特意留空、等待填寫資料的位置 / 欄位
a blank	題目、表格或文字中故意留下、需要填入內容的空位
fill in the blank	把缺少的字、數字或資料填入指定空位
blank — missing information	應該有資料的位置目前沒有內容；未填寫的
blank expression/face/look	臉上 / 眼神中看不出情緒、理解、認出或明確反應
blankly	沒有顯示理解、情緒或反應地；茫然地
blank — memory gap	某段時間 / 事件完全無法回想起來的記憶空白

draw a blank	嘗試記起、尋找或取得某個結果，但完全沒有成功	
blank — emotionless	沒有明顯情緒、反應或個人色彩的	
blank — no ideas	暫時沒有可用的想法、答案或靈感	
blank form/template	已有格式 / 欄位，但尚未填入實際資料的文件	
blank cheque/check — literal	某些關鍵資料尚未填寫的空白支票	
blank cheque/check — figurative	給某人極大的決定、行動或花費自由而沒有明確限制	
blank / blanks — ammunition	沒有普通實彈彈頭、主要用來產生聲響 / 效果的空包彈	
blank someone	故意不承認、回應或理會某人；尤其英式非正式	
blank on something	突然無法想起原本知道的資料	
blank out — memory	暫時無法思考 / 記憶，或完全忘記某段內容	
blank out — information	刻意把文字 / 資料遮掉、刪除或使其不可見	
blankness	沒有內容、想法、表情或反應的空白 / 茫然狀態	
point-blank — distance	在極近距離下	
point-blank — manner	毫不迂迴、非常直接地	

For your original passage

> “My heart would race, my mind would go **blank**, and I would start imagining the worst.”

The exact meaning is:

blank = 暫時沒有可用的思緒、記憶或語言內容，令自己無法正常思考或想起要說甚麼

Therefore:

> **my mind would go blank**

= “「我的腦袋會突然一片空白 / 我會突然完全想不起要說甚麼」”

The key semantic idea is still related to literal **blank**:

> **blank page**

> = 頁面沒有內容

figuratively becomes:

> **blank mind**

> = 腦中暫時沒有能夠取用的想法 / 內容

So the most important learner contrasts are:

> **a blank page**

> = 空白頁

> ****leave the box blank****

> = 把方格留空

> ****fill in the blank****

> = 填空

> ****a blank screen****

> = 空白畫面

> ****a blank expression****

> = 茫然 / 毫無表情

> ****my mind went blank****

> = 我的腦袋一片空白

> ****I drew a blank****

> = 我想不起來 / 找不到任何結果

> ****she blanked me****

> = 她故意不理我

> ****blank cheque/check****

> = 空白支票；比喻不受限制的授權

So in your original passage, ****blank**** is figurative but very transparent:

****blank = mentally empty of accessible thoughts for a moment because of nervousness.****